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MUKESH PATEL SCHOOL OF TECHNOLOGY MANAGEMENT & ENGINEERING

MUNSOCIETY

MUMBAI MUN 2026

STUDY GUIDE
INTERNATIONAL PRESS CORPS

INTERNATIONAL PRESS

Agenda 1: Photography

Agenda 2: Journalism



Mumbai MUN'26

Letter from R&D

Dear Delegates,

The Department of Research & Development, MUN Society MPSTME, ecstatically welcomes all of you to the 13th edition of Mumbai MUN! Over the years, R&D has been guided by a singular ethos and vision: to make the Mumbai MUN conference a centre of meaningful discourse and debate on matters that rapidly shape the world we inhabit.

We are primarily tasked with formulating agendas and curating study guides that provide delegates with a comprehensive foundation before the conference. Our guides are the product of months of painstaking, human-driven research and production and are written with a *first-principles*, top-down approach.

Debate over matters of socio-political importance has taken centre stage in student life of late, with varying opinions and belief systems finding themselves continuously questioned. At Mumbai MUN 2026, as reflected by our theme "An Axiom Apart," we encourage delegates to bridge seemingly opposite truths and work together to creatively craft lasting solutions and partnerships.

With the *phare* that is our theme, our curations seek to foster meaningful and thought-provoking conversations on the topics that will define the global dynamics of the ever-changing world we live in. We seek to platform the perspectives that whittle away at the bureaucracy that barricades change.

The goal of any worthwhile MUN conference is to train the citizens of tomorrow to design, ideate, and create equitable world orders. The Research & Development team earnestly hopes Mumbai MUN 2026 will be a stepping stone for delegates to achieve that very goal.

Best Wishes,
Department of Research & Development
MUN Society MPSTME.

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JOURNALISM

The media, or Press, is called the watchdog of the establishment and hence the fourth pillar of democracy. The Press is expected to keep a check on the government and various organisations by constant surveillance and questioning. It serves to broadcast and spread information and awareness on the current affairs in politics, economy, culture, and society from local to global levels. It also has the onus upon itself to influence and amplify and mobilise the voices and opinions of the people catering to the five principles of journalism, which are:

1. Truth and Accuracy
2. Independence
3. Fairness and Impartiality
4. Humanity
5. Accountability

In order to uphold the principles, freedom of the press becomes necessary civil liberty, which has been dwindling due to several factors like the emergence of capitalist 'yellow' journalism, government and public hostility, hijacking by propagandists, barriers to information access, lack of protection and threat of life and various other constraints. Nevertheless, it has become a need of the hour to minimise the erosion of ethics and principles of journalism by hook or by crook so that it serves the needs of awareness and liaison between the people and the authority. It is necessary for the press to become the people's voice because, as mentioned earlier, it is supposed to be a watchdog of the establishment, not its loyal pet.

The United Nations Correspondents Association has officially represented the Press Corps, an extension of the UN, since 1995 and unofficially since 1948. It plays a critical role in ensuring that the press corps - the most accessible news agency for the world's 8 billion people, comprised of nearly 200 journalists from dozens of countries and several publications, broadcasters, and news agencies - has the resources it requires.

Furthermore, the IPC represents journalists in negotiations with the UN Secretariat to tackle global concerns. These journalists cover events that take place across the United Nations' various organisations and committees, as well as participate in press conferences with UN officials and diplomats. The International Press Corps is a body of news agencies, broadcasters, and publications having the independent and cardinal power of monitoring and informing about the events taking place at the conference.

It will work tirelessly as well as diligently to come up with an unfiltered account of the happenings and events in the stellar committees. It has the bestowed power of questioning the people in power about its policies and actions and holding them accountable for their actions and work too. The International Press Corps, with its team of efficient reporters and photographers, will serve as the network of prime communication at Mumbai MUN 2026.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Follow a systematic and step-wise methodology to optimise your research and deliver it effectively:

1. Break down every word of the agenda yourself and make a note of concepts that you think are pertinent to them.
2. Read the background guide. Please note that just as the background guide is a basic tool for delegates, it is merely one aspect of your research.
3. Develop a literal understanding of the agenda.
4. Study the political, legal, social and economic aspects of the agenda. Go through articles, research papers or any relevant documents.
5. Read about the foreign policy and agenda perspective of nations that you

might think will majorly impact the debate.

6. A thorough knowledge and understanding of contemporary events is a must. This ensures that your articles stay relevant.

Remember, your research accounts for more than 50% of all your written reports; do not simply rely on committee proceedings to draft a well-informed report. Research about each committee thoroughly, and it is highly encouraged for you to form your own opinions about certain aspects as you do so.

CATEGORIES OF JOURNALISM

There are different types of journalism, each serving a different purpose. In this conference, we will cover five types of journalism and present reports and writeups to gain an understanding of the colossal spectrum of journalism.

News Reporting

News reporting plays a pivotal role in journalism. It involves the collection, evaluation, production, and distribution of factual and unbiased information. The core purpose of news journalism is to present events and developments as they are, without adding personal opinions or interpretations. News articles are typically succinct, clear, and to the point.

Beat Reports

Beat reporting is a specialized form of news journalism that involves in-depth coverage of a specific area or "beat." A beat can be a particular subject matter, such as politics, education, health, or a geographic area like a city or region. Reporters covering a beat focus on accumulating extensive knowledge, conducting research, and closely observing developments related to their beat. The goal is to provide comprehensive and well-informed coverage, maintaining objectivity in their reporting. Beat reporters often become subject matter experts and are crucial for keeping the public well-informed on specialized topics.

Column

A column is an opinion-based piece where the journalist presents a personal perspective on a committee's development, debate, policy, or event, supported by observations, arguments, and analysis rather than just objective reporting.

Review Journalism

Review journalism combines elements of fact-based reporting with the inclusion of the reporter's own perspective and opinions. Unlike traditional news journalism, which aims to present information objectively, reviews provide a space for the reporter to express their viewpoint. This form of journalism is commonly used for evaluating and critiquing various subjects, including books, movies, restaurants, and other cultural or consumer products. The essence of a review lies in the balance between offering a personal stance and maintaining objectivity in assessing the subject under review. Readers rely on reviews to make informed choices and decisions.

Press Conferences

In the context of journalism, a press conference is a formal event where press delegates, along with their chairs or moderators, can question individuals in positions of authority.

Press conferences serve as a platform for journalists to seek clarification, demand accountability, or acquire essential information from those in power. The questions posed during press conferences often relate to matters that may not have been thoroughly discussed during formal sessions or may involve pointing out inaccuracies or inconsistencies. It's a crucial aspect of maintaining transparency and holding authorities accountable for their actions and decisions.

Feature Articles

The Feature or Miscellaneous Article category encourages informal and engaging submissions that can add a unique and enjoyable dimension to the Press experience. Feature reports and miscellaneous articles aim to offer a break from the more traditional and formal journalism styles and provide readers with a refreshing change of pace. Examples of miscellaneous articles include informal committee awards, personality quizzes, crossword puzzles, MUN delegate archetypes, EB or OC spotlights [interviews], and other forms of engaging content. Journalists enjoy full creative freedom for submissions pertaining to this category. A journalist at most can submit three feature articles [including the preconference task mentioned later] throughout the conference.

Investigative Journalism

Delegates conduct research during the conference, which may involve requesting speeches or interviews from fellow delegates. This format can also be used for opinion editorials as needed.

Committee Reports

The bulk of writing throughout the conference will consist of drafting a committee report for each day of the MUN, which will include a brief account of the debates, caucuses, resolutions, and other committee proceedings observed by the reporters, backed by their own research.

The Committee Report should have a catchy title and byline. Irrelevant details should be omitted, and maintaining a streamlined flow of events in the report is of absolute importance.

TASKS & SUBMISSIONS

Every reporter should do proper research before the conference and read as many articles of their news agency as they can to grasp the style, structure, and principles reflected in its reports, articles, and broadcasts.

The reporters need to go through the background guide of the committee they have been assigned to have a firm grasp over the agenda and what might follow in the committee proceedings. Reporters will be allowed to choose a committee of their choice to report at least a day prior to the conference.

Reporters are also expected to work on their Feature and Interview reports while working on their daily committee reports. The time-line to work on features and interviews are pretty flexible, but few deadlines for the same are to pertained to. The deadlines are mentioned below. Reporters must submit one feature by beginning of Day 2. They can at max submit 2 feature till lunch day 3. Interviews can be conducted on either of 3 days but it's transcript must be submitted by lunch day

Reporters are expected to work on their Feature and Interview reports alongside their daily committee reports. While the timeline for these reports is flexible, certain deadlines must be adhered to. At least one Feature report must be submitted by the beginning of Day 2, with a maximum of two Features accepted by lunch on Day 3. Interviews may be conducted on any of the three days but must be submitted by lunch on Day 3.

DAY 1 -
1. Committee Report 1 (Beat or News Report)
2. Feature Article (to be submitted by the beginning of Day 2)

DAY 2 -
1. Committee Report 2 (Column or News Report)
2. Opinion Editorial

DAY 3 -
1. Committee Report 3 (Beat/Column/News Report.)
2. Interview Transcript
3. Press Conference (no report required.)

WRITING STYLE & FORMAT

It is necessary to stick to the proper article format. For example, one should not express personal opinions on a report, and one should not portray an op-ed as a report.

Plagiarism and use of Artificial Intelligence to generate article content is strongly discouraged in the committee, and if an article is discovered to be plagiarized, it will not be marked at all. References and research can be derived from internet articles, but they must not be copied and pasted.

The articles should have a maximum of four paragraphs and a minimum of three paragraphs, and the word limit prescribed by the Head of Journalism must be kept to. Each article must have a catchy heading that is brief, creative, and reflective of the article's content. The by-lines must contain the name of the reporter, followed by a closed bracket with the name of the news agency allotted as the portfolio.

Submit the articles in the format prescribed in the Background Guide. One must follow the following font layout:

· Headline: Font: Times New Roman; Font Size 14; Bold

· By-lines: Font: Times New Roman; Font Size: 12; Italicized

· Content: Font: Times New Roman; Font Size: 12.

**You may italicise specific important sentences or words.

SUBMISSION FORMAT

- All submissions must be emailed only; no other forms of submission will be accepted. Submissions must be in MS Word format (.docx) or Google Docs (with shared access). Email your submissions to adityabhattacharjee36@gmail.com.
- Clearly indicate your name, agency [if provided,] and category of submission in the subject line of the email. For example: "Aditya Bhattacharjee, Reuters, Beat Report."
- The name of the document should not be "Document1" or "Untitled". It should be named in the following manner: "TheNewYorkTimes_Beat" or "MichelleNichols_OpEd".
- Since the Executive Board member[s] will download everything at once, if you do not name your submissions as per the correct format, it will make it difficult for them to navigate whose submission it is and may lead to your submission being disqualified. Proper naming will also make the scoring process easier for the EB member[s.]

STYLE GUIDE

All the reports must follow Associated Press (AP) style of report writing. A brief overview of the same is given below.

Abbreviating Words

These are the rules for common abbreviations following AP style:

- **Use only the most commonly recognized abbreviations:** The most common- such as NASA, FBI, and CIA—can be used on all references. Less well-known, but still common ones—such as OSHA and NATO—can be used after you spell out the full name on the first mention. In most cases, however, the stylebook suggests using a generic reference such as "the agency" or "the alliance" for all references after the first.
- **Don't put unfamiliar abbreviations in parentheses after the first**

reference: "The American Copy Editors Society (ACES), for example, would either be repeated as the full name on subsequent references or replaced by a generic reference, such as "the society."

- **Use an apostrophe and spell out academic degrees:** "She holds a bachelor's degree." Use abbreviations for degrees only when you need to include a list of credentials after a name and set them off with commas: "Peter White, LL.D., Ph.D., was the keynote speaker."
- **Abbreviate junior or senior directly after a name, with no comma to set it off:** "Justin Wilson Jr."
- **Spell out the names of all states when used alone:** "He lives in Montana." Abbreviate state names of seven or more letters when used with a city name, with commas before and after the abbreviation: "Pittsburgh, Pa., is a great weekend getaway spot for people who live in Youngstown, Ohio."
- **Spell out the name of a month when it is used without a specific date:** "August is too hot for a visit to Florida." Abbreviate months with six or more letters if they are used with a specific date such as "Sept. 28." Always spell out those with five or fewer letters: "May 15."
- **Spell out titles used alone:** "She was the first female senator from her state." Abbreviate and capitalize most titles when they are used directly before a name: "Sen. Boxer posed hard questions for Rice." To determine if a title is abbreviated, look for an entry for it in the AP Stylebook or check the listing under *Titles*.
- **Spell out titles with names used in direct quotes:** The exceptions are Dr., Mr., and Mrs. "Governor Pawlenty is obviously no Jesse Ventura," she said.
- **Spell out all generic parts of street names (avenue, north, road) when no specific address is given:** "The festival will be held on South Charles Street." When a number is used, abbreviate avenue (Ave.), boulevard (Blvd.), street (St.), and directional parts of street names: "The suspect was identified as Michael Shawn of 1512 N. Mission St."
- **In writing news stories, never abbreviate**:
    - The days of the week
    - Percent as %
    - The word "and," unless the symbol & is an official part of a name

Capitalisation

The AP Stylebook uses what's known as downstyle—that is, words are lowercased unless a rule says to capitalize them. If you can't find a rule for capitalizing a word in the stylebook, use it in lowercase. The most familiar capitalization rules are:

- **Capitalize common nouns such as party, river, and street when they are part of a proper name for a place, person or thing:** For example, the Libertarian Party, the Ohio River. But lowercase these common nouns when they stand alone or in subsequent references: "The party did not have a candidate for president," "She nearly drowned in the river." Lowercase all plural uses of common nouns: the Libertarian and Green parties, the Monongahela and Ohio rivers.
- **Lowercase the names of the seasons unless they are used in a proper name:** the Summer Olympics.
- **Capitalize the word "room" only when used with the number of the room or when part of the name of a specially designated room:** *Room 315, the Lincoln Room.*
- **Lowercase directional indicators:** The exception is when they refer to specific

geographic regions or popularized names for those regions. For example, "the Northeast" or "the Midwest."

- **Lowercase formal titles that appear on their own or follow a name:** In the latter case, they should be set off by commas. Capitalize formal titles that come directly before a name: "The students were delighted when they heard they would meet President Obama." Never capitalize job descriptions: shortstop, police officer, attorney, and so on.

Numbers

The AP Stylebook entry for numerals is deceptively short. A close look reveals plenty of rules hiding among the cross-references. The most common are:

- **In general, spell out numbers one through nine:** Use figures for numbers 10 on up. However, there are many exceptions that always take figures. Most, but not all, involve units of measurement.

Common exceptions include:

- **Addresses:** 7 Park Place
- **Ages, but not for inanimate objects:** The 4-year-old cat, the four-year-old car
- **Cents:** 8 cents.
- **Dollars:** $3. Notice that AP style does not include a period and two zeroes when referring to an even dollar figure
- **Dates:** March 4. Notice that dates take cardinal numbers, not ordinal numbers (don't use 4th)
- **Dimensions:** 5 foot 2, 5-by-9 cell
- **Highways:** Route 7
- **Millions, billions:** 6 billion people
- **Percentages:** 1 percent. Notice that percent is one word.
- **Speed:** 8 mph.
- **Temperatures:** 2 degrees.
- **Times:** 4 p.m. Notice that AP style does not include a colon and two zeroes when referring to an even hour.
- **Spell out numbers used at the beginning of a sentence:** "Ten thousand people marched on the capital." Exception: Never spell out years: "1999 was a terrible year for technology companies."
- **Use commas to set off each group of three digits in numerals higher than 999.** Exception is for years and addresses: "12,650."
- **Use decimals (up to two places) for amounts in the millions and billions:** Do this if no precise figure is required: "$3.74 billion."
- **Add an "s" but no apostrophe to a number to make it plural:** "She kept rolling 7s." The same rule applies to decades: the 1980s. Use an apostrophe on a decade only if cutting off the initial figures: the '80s.

Punctuation and Miscellaneous

For the most part, AP style follows the same rules of punctuation taught in grade school. However, there are some important exceptions:

- **Don't use a comma before a conjunction in a simple series.** A simple series is defined as one in which no elements contain the words *and* or *or*: "The dinner choices were chicken, cod or beef." Use a comma for series that include elements containing *and* or *or*: "The menu offered a choice of bacon and eggs, pancakes, or waffles."
- **Use a semicolon to clarify a series that includes a number of commas:** Include a semicolon before the conjunction. "Parts for the carrier are made in Tampa, Fla.; Austin, Texas; and Baton Rouge, La."

Other Common Style Rules

Here are some more AP style guidelines to follow:

- **Use a person's full name on the first reference:** On subsequent references, use only his or her last name with no title. Second and following references to a married couple should refer to them as Mr. and Mrs.: "Mr. and Mrs. Oakes will honeymoon in Las Vegas." In stories in which two people share the last name, use full names on each reference.
- **Time:** Express as a figure followed by *a.m. or p.m.* "8:33 p.m." You do not have to add other words (e.g., night, morning, and so on) to distinguish between day and night. Use "noon" or "midnight" rather than 12 p.m. or 12 a.m.
- **Use hyphens to link all the words in a compound adjective:** "The five-volume report called for cleaning up the area over a 10-year period." Do not use a hyphen if the construction includes "very" or an adverb ending in "–ly": "a very big project, barely legal procedures."
- **To form a plural of a single letter, use "s" and an apostrophe:** "All the B's lined up to the right." To form a plural of multiple letters, add "s" with no apostrophe: "She mastered her ABCs in little time."
- **To form the plural of words made out of a group of letters, add the letter "s":** CDs, ABCs, TVs.
- **Titles:** Books, movies, recordings, television shows, and similar works are set off in quotation marks, with all principal words capitalized: "Harry Potter and the Deathly Hallows," "Letters from Iwo Jima," "Memory Almost Full," "Grey's Anatomy." Titles of magazines, newspapers and reference works get no special treatment: Newsweek, The Boston Globe, The Associated Press Stylebook.

For the detailed AP format, visit *https://www.apstylebook.com/*

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

- Submissions must be **on time.** Marks will be deducted for turning in the reports later than the decided time.
- Committee report for Day 1 and Day 2 must be submitted by the end of the last committee session of the day. Committee report for Day 3 must be submitted by the second last committee session of the day.
- Editorials may be submitted to the reporters' convenience, before the end of the last committee session of the conference.
- Interview Reports must be submitted as per the IP Head's discretion.
- All typed reports must be emailed to sanya1213@gmail.com with correct headings and subject lines.
- All written reports (if any) must be handed to the IP Head physically.

CODE OF CONDUCT

- All reports should be neat, with a uniform font type and size maintained throughout. The font specifics should be formal and easy on the eyes.
- **Complete plagiarism of reports will not be tolerated.** While paraphrasing lines and quotes from different sources is a reporter's tool, plagiarism checks will be enforced to ensure authenticity of the entire report. This is applicable for the Committee Report as well as Op-Eds.
- Decent etiquette is to be maintained while interacting with members of the Executive Board, Organising Committee,

delegates, and other people present in the conference.

- While in committee, maintain strict decorum. Do not move around or cause disturbance during formal committee sessions. Reporters are allowed to lobby during informal sessions.
- Press conferences tend to get spirited, but reporters are urged to maintain a calm demeanour and respectfully put forth their questions.
- **Use of derogatory remarks or colloquial language will result in mark deduction or disqualification from the International Press**, according to the IP Head's discretion.
- A positive and polite tone of voice is to be maintained in the Interviews and otherwise, throughout the conference.
- Following the formal dress code is applicable to the IP members as well.
- **The IP Head is not responsible for the misbehaviour of any of the IP Members.**
- **The delegates should strictly avoid any form of plagiarism or help from other platforms, especially those of/for generative or 'Humanising' purposes. If reports are found to be plagiarised or taken from AI (e.g., ChatGPT, Gemini.) The guilty shall be disqualified.**

EXAMPLES

An example of an Opening Ceremony Report is given below: (RGUMUN'23)

THE GREAT SPARK

-Euronews

With bated breaths, jerking knees and hushed conversations, the auditorium of the Royal Global University was already abuzz with activity before the conference opened, and then suddenly came the announcement- "Delegates please settle down" and so began the second edition of the Royal Global University Model United Nations, the largest MUN conference in North East with over 450 delegates in attendance. Invoking the spirit of patriotism and unity, the opening ceremony began by singing our National Anthem and the RGU Anthem which was followed by the lighting of the lamp a symbol of knowledge and enlightenment. After the felicitation of the various dignitaries attending the event, the audience was addressed by the Vice Chancellor of Royal Global University, Prof. Dr S. P. Singh. He spoke about how he was impressed by the Organising Committee and that the various hurdles they faced only helped them showcase their zeal and immense enthusiasm. He also spoke really well about the journey of a delegate, culminating in them becoming a Secretary General.

He through his words, encouraged the Executive Board members to focus on how well-researched a delegate is rather than just how well they spoke, a point which was appreciated by many. He finally ended his speech by wishing all the delegates luck and with a promise of future participation from his side.

After the Vice Chancellor's address, all the Executive Board members were handed their gavels by the Secretary-General, Deepanwita Endow Purkayastha, and she received hers as well. She then addressed the gathering, providing a brief history of the formation of the United Nations and then stated the theme for this three-day conference- "Preserving international stability, working to prevent conflict and make peace with the vision of Reason, Reaffirm and Reform." She also encouraged us to ignite a flame, one of great innovation and ideas, which would result in us leaving a lasting legacy and working on something larger than life.

Finally, she concluded by quoting Swami Vivekananda- "Take up one idea. Make that one idea your life. Think of it, dream of it, live on that idea. Let the brain, muscles, nerves, every part of your body, be full of that idea, and just leave

every other idea alone. This is the way to success." And with that, she declared, the RGUMUN 2023 open.

An example of a beat report is given below:

USPE 2020 (MMUN'17)

THERE GOES WARREN, TRUMP-ING AWAY

-Al-Jazeera, Beat Reporter

The USPE 2020 consisted of ample amounts of critical accusations against the Trump government and charged the Obama government with corruption and fraud. Elizabeth Warren's speech on the topic, 'Economic Policies of USA', spoke of how the US government to date has failed to follow the path of sustainable development. Warren's tenacity also shone through when she questioned Ted Cruz's statement, "100% globalisation is eating up the American economy", when it was the US which had pressured other nations to follow the guidelines of globalisation, to which Cruz gave a meek reply that the circumstances then were different. Nikki Haley proclaimed that the American nation entails more innovations to have better economic conditions. Bernie Sanders thundered as he began, "Trump has done a great job at making himself profoundly rich, but has he been able to do a great job at making America great?" The Global Citizen seemed slightly disenchanted to have been hearing only facts and statements and no solutions.

The subsequent Moderated Caucus revolved around the issue of 'Future Defence Policies of USA', to which Warren and Sanders stated that one-fourth of the total budget had been employed for military purposes during Trump's regime. The Democratic Party legislators stood against the extravagant military budget and wished toutilisee more funds for healthcare,witho which Trump disagreed. He also stated that the deficit of funds for humanitarian purposes was due to the corrupt political practices during Obama's tenure.

The endeavours of the USPE 2020, such as Warren's accusations and concern for the citizens of the nation, Sanders' factual and scientific declarations and Cruz's resilient spiri,t all made for an engaging committee jampacked with animated discussions.

Another example of a beat report is given below:

DISEC [DPSGMUN 2022]

CONFLICT OF THE MIND, TENSION ON THE SEA.

-Associated Israel Press

Youthful, natural, and ingenuous, the first three committee sessions of the UN Disarmament and International Security Committee (DISEC,) were full of vigor and enthusiasm which resulted in an engaging session of debate and deliberation on the given agenda: Establishing a Nuclear Free Zone in SouthEast Asia. The first committee session started slowly but sprang into action with an assertive speech by the delegate of Israel. While the speech became grounds for unsolicited questions, the delegate of Israel craftily revised and defended its national policies. Delegates of countries such as Iceland, Spain, and Australia promised adherence to Article VI of the Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT) and urged others to do the same. The delegate of the United States of America (USA) in her GSL speech highlighted the efforts the country had made to curb nuclear proliferation and mentioned the Rapacki Plan, first initiated by Poland and Article VII of the NPT. The chairperson noted that the committee had sternly deviated from the agenda at hand.

In the second committee session, the delegate of Sri Lanka raised a Moderated Caucus on the topic - "Factors enforcing nuclear weapon development for a country," which saw speeches from 24 delegates. The delegates of countries such as Syria, Kenya, Egypt, Russia, and Saudi Arabia among others highlighted how the fear of being suppressed or wrecked by superior or

developed countries, leads to the development of nuclear deterrents by such countries, with special emphasis on the Southeast Asian countries. Delegates of countries such as Canada, China, and the Philippines, on the other han, emphasisedd the need for deliberation and alliances rather than taking up nuclear 'deterrents.' The delegate of the United Kingdom (UK) deliberated upon the need to be concerned about nuclear security, as 'terrorist groups may attempt to acquire nuclear weapon materials through illicit transactions.'

The committee had shifted into its front gear by the commencement of the third session on the second day, with each delegate having a unique opinion on the agenda at hand. The GSL saw blistering speeches from delegates of countries such as the Republic of Korea, Venezuela, Australia, Malaysia, and Singapore.

The delegate of Russia pressed upon the Indo-Pak andSino-Indiann situation, warning how dangerous both were for billions of civilians in South Asia. The delegate of Saudi Arabia came under fire for asking for '...a treaty to make sure Southeast Asia does not receive nuclear weapons,' while the Bangkok treaty was already in action.

Breaking into the fourth session, the delegate of China took on the ante, calling out the 123 Agreement between the USA and India. The delegate also raised a moderated caucus on the topic – "Relationship between ASEAN regarding the South China Sea Dispute," drawing the committee one notch higher and promising an ostentatious conclusion. If the committee would be able to deliberate and maintain the agenda, would be for time to tell.

Another example of a beat report is given below:

HLS [Mumbai MUN 2025]

<u>Of Red Flags and Empty Coffers</u>

Lok Sabha sees great upheaval on its second day, but is it all bark and no bite?

- Aditya Bhattacharjee

The second and third sessions of the Historic Lok Sabha (H.LS) saw the committee bring history back to life as the House settled back to look for solutions to the ongoing Balance of Payments crisis and the search for institutional responses to rising insurgencies.

The session resumed right where the last one left off, on the discussion around rising insurgencies in various parts of the country, with special emphasis on left-wing extremism, followed by zero-hour, wherein pertinent questions were raised and answered. Notably, during the session, Arjun Singh questioned Atal Bihari Vajpayee on his silence during the Ram Janmabhoomi movement, accusing him of passively watching India's secular fabric erode and asking why his party's stance seemed to exclude non-Hindu citizens. Later, Sajjan Kumar confronted Bhavna Chikhalia, citing the Kusum Lata Mittal Committee Report that allegedly linked her to the 1984 riots, questioning her credibility in discussing insurgencies while under such charges, while Dil Kumari Bhandari pressed Home Minister Shankar Rao Chavan on repeated government failures to rehabilitate insurgency-hit regions in the Northeast, calling it a "peace on paper, unrest in reality."

As the zero-hour came to an end, the Speaker of the House suspended the floor for open debate, leading to huge upheaval in the house between the Indian National Congress (INC) and other opposition parties, mostly running on open rhetoric and futile sloganeering around INC's inability to curb insurgencies in its thirty-four-year rule. The INC too did not hold back in throwing accusations, going back to the times of emergency to bring up the Baroda Dynamite case of 1976, in which George Fernandes, a seasoned Member of Parliament and Janata Dal leader, was one of the key accused. INC declared in the house that Fernandes, as such, was a man who acted against the interests of the nation and a flagbearer of

extremism. Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Chandra Shekhar, and members of the opposition were quick to question such antics, calling it a way to divert the house from the topic at hand, while also defending Fernandes as a fighter against the Emergency.

After much turmoil in the house, talks finally moved towards discussing the ongoing Balance of Payments crisis. Finance Minister Manmohan Singh went through the already established crisis at hand, that of a twin deficit- fiscal and current account. He also brought forward the idea of deregulation of private entities and saw Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) as a method to recover depleting foreign exchange and a way to grow the manufacturing sector. He declared that with such moves, he wanted to make the government a referee, not a goalkeeper.

With a penultimate day that made people turn their heads as they walked past the committee, and a day where each representative barely hopped onto their seat, we look forward to one of the most exciting and eventful last days of the lower house in years.

An example of a News Report is given below:

HLS [Mumbai MUN 2025]

"You Americans Are Getting on My Nerves!" ...

And other things, the moderator of JCC West Bloc said in its quest for victory.

- Aditya Bhattacharjee

The fourth session of the Western Bloc of the Joint Crisis Committee (JCC), held on the 27th of July, 1950, was rife with conflict as it addressed the escalation of hostilities in the Korean Peninsula, brought to a standstill with new updates- Seoul being on the verge of a fall unanticipated by the bloc.

The session dived straight into crisis for the bloc, as by July 2, 1950, Seoul had fallen to North Korean forces. The ROK's 6th Infantry Division lost over 4,000 troops, with 500 captured, including Gen. Suk Won, all the while panic spread among soldiers and civilians questioning Syngman Rhee's inaction. As Seoul collapsed, the U.S. Congress approved $120 million for intervention, mobilising forces from Japan, Okinawa, and the Philippines, but it was perhaps too late. In response, the bloc brought forward its plans, albeit most of them being pledges to provide arms and/or resources. Lt. Gen. Sir Horace Robertson, in his statement, took note of the coalition of nations united in purpose and spirit, their mission being to stabilize established frontlines and support humanitarian relief while restoring peace. Lee Ki-Poong, Mayor of Seoul, lamented the loss of communication with the Tiger 38 troop, presuming them to be dead. Meanwhile, Chouch Pyeong-Ok, former UN representative and Founding member of KNP, extended the Republic of Korea's (ROK) ports to the United States to help fight back, and use the Han River to 'whatever extent possible.' President Truman, however, shut down Chouch's offer, and instead looked toward the People's Republic of China (PRC) as an unexpected aid to help fight communism in Korea. Jawaharlal Nehru, the Prime Minister of India, doubled down on the idea of using the PRC to get back control, all the while refusing to provide open support to the ROK in the crisis. MacArthur tried to make things look merry-go-lucky, pledging to fight not just for Korea but for the whole world to be free of communism. C. Turner Joy, Admiral of the US Navy, crudely offered to talk to USSR's PM Joseph Stalin and get back hostages, including Gen. Paik; however, an argument with Lee Ki-Poong led to the fall of the same idea.

By July 27, 1950, North Korean forces had seized Suwon, Incheon, and nearby islands, forcing South Korea's leadership to flee to Taejon. Morale collapsed as Chough Pyeong-ok and KNP forces were captured. The United States launched naval and air operations near Incheon and Ongjin, with air raids over Seoul intensifying. In Pusan, Allied guns downed Soviet aircraft, while 5,000 South Koreans under

Paik Sun Yup battled fierce KPA resistance at Kangnung.

Following a Press Conference conducted by journalist Maira Sharma, the next update informed the bloc that the Onjin and Incheon landings ended in disaster, with 1,500 U.S. troops forced to retreat under heavy KPA fire despite inflicting major losses. In Taejon, Kim Suk Won re-emerged as a heroic figure amid Rhee's fading popularity. Meanwhile, the Battle of Kangnung turned decisively when 16,000 combined ROK–U.S. troops crushed the KPA, capturing 3,000 prisoners, including General Choe Yong-gon. The President of Korea, in one of his speeches, asked Nehru to help mediate a truce with North Korea. With the bloc looking unstable and unable to deal with the crisis at hand, it will be interesting to see how the bloc uses its members and resources to its advantage to safeguard the ROK's land.

An example of a review report is given below:

The Congregation of Balkan States (MMUN'17)

FINDING FREEDOM

– Reuters

The second day brought with it renewed energy and vigour among the delegates of the Congregation of the Balkan States. But the uncertainties and the confusion, which were found on the very first day of the committee, still reflectedthemselvesf. A couple of delegates were perplexed about their stances, which led the committee to delve into quick historical and political lessons from time to time. But as the session proceeded; the committee was able to move forward with its aim instead of getting caught in the endless circles.

The main attention was drawn by the delegates of the Ottoman Empire and Bulgaria over territorial negotiations. A directive put forward by the Ottoman Empire stated that, 'The Empire was prepared to grant freedom to Bulgaria provided the annexed state agreed to certain demands of the Turkish Sultan.' However, the thorough debates and the discussion on the directive ultimately led to the annulment of the three of the four original demands, with the sole demand of the Ottoman Empire to acquire the Macedonian part of Bulgaria, which remained the only prerequisite to Bulgarian freedom. . In spite of showing initial reluctance, the delegate of Bulgaria finally gave in and agreed to give up its share of Macedonian territory in exchange for her country's freedom. This served as the highlight of the day, with the Ottoman Empire taking inspiration from this victory and proposing a moderated caucus on the possible re-unification of Macedonia, which lasted till the final hours.

The day ended on a high note with a motion of Entertainment, during which the delegates dedicated songs to each other, did the Harlem Shake, and finally, the delegates of Bulgaria and the Ottoman Empire shared a dance too!

An example of an Opinion Editorial report is given below:

UNSC; MMUN'21

IS ZIONISM A LEGITIMATE NATIONALIST MOVEMENT OR ANOTHER CASE OF COLONIALISM?

~Reuters

A great idea for the protection of a persecuted group or another attempt at colonisation; Is Zionism truly a nationalist movement or something else? For centuries, Jews had been persecuted, discriminated against and been on the receiving end of hostility and prejudice. This hostility is what brought about the idea of a separate Jewish state for the development and protection of Jews, the idea of Zionism. The thought of having their own nation made the Jews feel a sense of security which they did not feel in the places where they were a persecuted minority. This idea turned into a movement under Theodor Herzl who is considered the father of modern Zionism. The first Zionist Congress, which resulted in the formation of the

Basel Program, was chaired by him. This was the first event that resulted in the establishment of the Israeli state.

The actual conflict between the Jews and the Arabs began during the early 20th century when thousands of Jews arrived at the then Ottoman Palestine to escape persecution and to establish their new homeland. This caused a lot of tensions to rise between the two groups which soon escalated into a crisis. This resulted in the United Nations (UN) proposing to split the land into two states, one for the Arabs (Palestine) and another for the Jews (Israel). This further resulted in the 1948 Arab-Israeli War which ended with Israel winning and going beyond the UN-designated borders to claim Palestinian land including the western half of Jerusalem. The Israeli forces also displaced lots of Palestinians, creating about 700,000 refugees.

If one were to look at history, one would realise that although Zionism began as a nationalist movement, it slowly started losing its initial motives. The Israelis are no longer a persecuted minority as out of the 14.7 million Jewish people in the world, 47% reside in Israel!

We can see that somewhere along the line, Zionism started mimicking colonialism as it's the Palestinians who are being persecuted in their own land now.

As of now, there are about seven million Palestinian refugees around the world who were expelled, forced to flee or forced into exile from their homes in the Israeli-Palestinian region. We still have tens of thousands of people in Jerusalem who hold no legal status as their parents have different ID cards and Israel refuses to register them. Therefore, we must understand that although Zionism as a national movement was necessary back then to provide the Jews with a safe space, that reason is no longer applicable as the Jewish predominant Israel is one of the strongest countries in the world while the Palestinians currently have no place to truly call their home. We must also realise that, in this case, the land belongs to both, Israelis and Palestinians and hence a solution for peaceful co-existence must be reached. Expelling one of the two groups from the region is not a solution if we do so, where will they go? Hence, we all must consider the words of Mr. Ban Ki-moon, former Secretary-General of the United Nations-

"We must not give up on the right of Palestine to exist, just as we must protect the right of Israel to exist in peace and security with its neighbours

Another example of an Opinion Editorial report is given below:

UNHRC; DPSGMUN 23

THE FORTE OF THE WEST: THE ART OF EXIT-ERTAINMENT AND ITS IMPACT ON WOMEN

-Al-Jazeera

The West, particularly the United States of America, leaves no opportunity to sweep into foreign territory in their times of distress with the promise of liberation and restoration of national harmony. A knight in shining Armour for the rest of the world yet when the curtains fall and the glitz and glamour wanes away, the citizens of that nation are left foraging for themselves.

The U.S. invasion of Iraq in 2003 witnessed a streak of kidnappings, sexual assaults, forced nudity, death threats and more whose victims were mostly women. The Mahmudiyah Rape and Killings are a striking example of the havoc wreaked by the West under the guise of humanitarian intervention to fuel their national security and economic interests.

The Haditha Massacre of 2004 carried out on 24 unarmed Iraqi civilians by the US military is one of the many spinechilling instances of atrocities by the U.S. The West has till date, refused to take accountability for its actions. Once the tyranny settles, what remains are the smouldering ruins of nations left to navigate the aftermath alone.

The 9/11 attacks saw the uprising of the beast. When negotiations with the Taliban failed, the USA resorted to unleashing a War On Terror as authorised by the United Nations Security Council Resolution 1368. The invasion according to the Resolution was not legitimate.In Afghanistan, a shift in the original intentions of the USA became apparent when its security forces executed systematic attacks on Pashtun villages, raped and killed women and arbitrarily executed civilians. Although, the withdrawal of US troops led to the restoration of the Taliban regime, women and other civilians suffered at the hands of those who had pleaded to protect and liberate them from their misery, for more than two decades. It would be extremely fallacious to believe that the West, in situations such as these, has no other option but to declare outright invasions and then leave at their own convenience.

The Middle East is often referred to as the "theatre of the Cold War", where the ruling elite executed their histrionics and the rest were spectators, bereft of any say in the power play. The US in retaliation to the Russian invasion of Afghanistan, drew support from Mujahideen groups to further their ulterior motives. Amidst this tug-of-war for power, perceptions of gender and women's rights were gravely polarized. The West was of the view that the terms domesticity and consumerism should be associated with women. Hence, the little liberty enjoyed by women in the Middle East was seized by the Western forces, paving the way for the deplorable condition that women would continue to live in for the next few decades.

The Vietnam War is often forgotten but it was a war that spawned some of the most heinous atrocities that failed human imagination. It witnessed a horrifying normalisation of rape and killings. U.S. soldiers were lauded and addressed as "double veterans" if they succeeded in raping and subsequently killing Vietnamese Women. Furthermore, the My Lai Massacre brings to light the horrendous abuse that the women were subjected to. One of the many notable yet saddening instances where 20 Vietnamese females were raped by U.S troops.

These troops received assent from their superiors to move forward with their sexual advances, indoctrinated by the Orientalist perspective which regarded men as superior creatures and reduced women to the status of mere objects whose sole purpose was to satiate the desires of the former. In examining the annals of history, there is a recurring pattern of the West that needs to be remedied. The West, under the guise of intervention, has repeatedly caused massive loss to the annexed nations. The aftermath of ever invasion is a blaring reminder of what lies beneath the grandeur of military power and diplomatic prowess.

An example of a Miscellaneous or Feature Article is given below:

THE BOLSHEVIK FOR THE MUN-SHEVIKS!

-The Hindu

Delegates at MUNs tend to be stuck with a sense of realism, brought to terms with the human condition all round the globe- a sphere commanded by tyranny and instability, vain in the search of solutions. They start to show characteristics similar to those of Russian Literature, looking jolly outside but stuck with deep personal conflict inside their minds. MUNs could actually be called the ComicCon for Russian Literature enthusiasts. But what if characters from renowned Russian novellas decided to become delegates? How'd they react? Let's take a look at the same –

Rodion Raskolnikov (Crime and Punishment) – Egoistic, talented yet alienated, this delegate is driven by instinct rather than by voluntary deliberation. Although a delegate with excellent lobbying skills, this delegate tends to prepare their actions in isolation. Passionate for their portfolio, this delegate will do anything to make ends meet for their country, come what may.

Ivan Petrovitch (Uncle Vanya) – A hopeless romantic, this delegate is revered for their witty and wholesome nature in the committee. However, the delegate leads a turbulent and bitter relation with their portfolio, and thus is not really liked by companions.

Margarita (The Master and Margarita) – A delegate of conservative nature at the inception of their MUN career, this delegate has grown over time to become a robust, all-gunsblazing, thanks to their magical transformation (quite literally.) Taught by time itself, this delegate is also a staunch feminist, and is liked by their peers for their selflessness and dedicated nature.

Omon Krivomazov (Omon Ra) – This delegate is an underdog, neglected and lost by peers since time immemorial, thus delegate is excellent at dealing with post-conflict problems. A staunch advocate of pro-liberalistic approach, the delegate will do anything and everything to escape and defeat the forces which try to suppress the human spirit, due to which many consider this delegate a weirdo.

While what truly takes place inside a delegate's mind might remain a mystery to the world of diplomats and psychologists, it will never be as difficult as analyzing the minds of characters in Russian Literature for they are what they truly consider – humane.

Another example of a Miscellaneous or Feature Article report is given below:

UNHRC; DPSGMUN 23

I The Nuclear Bomb

Journalist Aditya Bhattacharjee delves into the psyche of the much-feared Atom Bomb and WMDs, a tool of nuclear proliferation kept far from the public in closed rooms.*

I the Nuclear Bomb,

Born through the God's very first Psalm,

am kept closed and calm,

Waiting for the day someone raises the alarm.

I the Nuclear Bomb,

Am kept safe and sound,

In a hole underground,

One-day meant to be skybound.

I the Nuclear Bomb,

Wish to fall down,

And achieve my bejewelled crown,

As the world and its molecules all go down.

I the Nuclear Bomb,

Shall then succumb to wounds,

And mix with the molecules of ground,

The ground, now dead and gone.

I the Nuclear Bomb,

However also feel the pain,

Of people who scream in vain,

All for someone's political gain.

I the Nuclear Bomb,

Make lives end,

Yet, I wish to amend,

My ways which no one commends.

I the Nuclear Bomb,

Watch the NPT** get tossed around,

While my freedom and sanctity get bossed about,

While all perishes in and off the ground.

I the Nuclear Bomb,

Wish to be put into a Tomb.

Forever.

And ever.

* Weapons of Mass Destruction

** Non-Proliferation Treaty

Another example of a Miscellaneous or Feature Article report is given below:

UNHRC; DPSGMUN 23

DELEGO-SCOPE

-Al Jazeera

If you want to know what your destiny as a diplomat holds, read on.

ARIES: (March 21-April 19) A fire to be reckoned with - this group of delegates is most likely to be the 'bossy' one and you can hear their pompous voice ringing from outside the committee itself as they either bash someone up or call for delegates to gather round.

TAURUS: (April 20- May 20) These delegates are most likely to bleat than anybody, even as the Chair shouts for "DECORUM!" They are most likely to get barred from committee at least once (read: frequently) which surprisingly does nothing to dampen their spirits as they await their return again.

GEMINI: (May 21- June 20) With Geminis, you can never be sure, they can go from hundred to zero, full of ideas or totally clueless; in a matter of seconds. One moment they might be supporting your bloc but the next they might not.

CANCER: (June 21-July 22) Mind your ways around them for they are really passionate. They are the ones found using the Right to Reply most often. For all you know, they might start pursuing a vendetta against you that might carry on behind committee walls as well.

LEO: (July 23-Aug 22) They are the ones who are constantly roaring in the committee for a Motion for Entertainment and when denied so for the 100th time they are found doodling hearts or sending roses to the delegates they like.

VIRGO: (August 23- September 22) Virgos spell PERFECTION right from birth. You'll find their research top-notch, their outfits without a single crease and their moves calculated. They are the ones who will be most likely to table your resolution if you have a punctuation misplaced or a country name misspelled.

LIBRA: (September 23- October 22) From the very first day, they are found gossiping about the socials, and with their party instincts activated. Who cares about the country policies?

SCORPIO: (October 23-November 21) You won't remember their presence until they decide to come out of their shells and break down all walls. You'd be surprised by Scorpio's sudden enthusiastic participation, and you can never be sure of the incoming sting.

SAGITTARIUS: (November 22- December 21) The optimistic, these delegates will never be discouraged from raising the same moderated caucus again and again against the exasperated looks of all. They can be found with their lame jokes, lunch thoughts.

CAPRICORN: (December 22- January 19) All hail the Assassins of the committee. They observe, as they believe in the MUNtra quality over quantity and with every statement they deliver they create storms.

AQUARIUS: (January 20- February 18) Delegates of this sun sign are ubiquitous. They are the ones most likely to come up with their own resolutions and constantly flood the committee with press releases, communiqués and directives.

PISCES: (February 19-March 20) These are the ones likely to be on the lookout for helping any desperate souls. They are also the ones most likely to be wooed into signing the other bloc's resolution.

Another example of a Miscellaneous or Feature Article report is given below:

UNHRC; DPSGMUN 23

THE ULTIMATE (SUFI) GUIDE TO GOOD DELEGACY

-Bakhtar News Agency

A political diaspora may have many aspects concerning what makes it successful and what doesn't, but hollering beyond these aspects lies an estate untouched in political diplomacy poetry. There is no politics without any spectacle, and there is no spectacle without any poetry. Parliamentary debates and public declarations frequently encompass poetic exchanges, evoking the timeless mysticism of Sufi traditions. These poetical interludes explore themes of love, devotion, wisdom, and other enduring values central to diplomacy.

In this article, we seek counsel from the verses written by the greatest of Sufi artists and see how they can add to our diplomatic journey, be it new or longstanding –

1.Rumi – "Raise your words, not voice. It is rain that grows flowers, not thunder."

No Sufi list can start or end without the words of Rumi – perhaps the most recognised of the Sufi poets noted for his works on introspection and consecration. In the verse above, we can allude to the datum that often it is that novices in the world of diplomacy oversimplify it as a matter of utilising empty and flashy words to appease the public, neglecting the significance of practical implementation. Diplomacy transcends mere show cause and sloganeering with no head or tail to it, for it entails translating words into meaningful actions and consistently reaffirming one's pledges, ultimately embodying the genuine essence of diplomatic practice.

2. Rabia Basri – "Great doubt will eventually lead to great awakening."

Self-doubt is a recurring theme in any delegate's life, for to question oneself, is to seek answers to one's problems. Often doubting oneself is seen as a vice to diplomatic thinking, but so is not true. It is keen introspection that gives birth to sharp realisations and solutions, for every question has an answer hidden inside. To be constantly at odds with not only other diplomats but also oneself is what separates a good diplomat from a great diplomat.

3. Jami – "It is best to avoid low company, whether they come in peace or war."

Once a novice rises unto the big games, so do the stakes in their diplomatic journey. It is in times like this that it becomes important to realise and work on the alliances they are in-andout of and make and break them as necessary. Only diplomats who have kept aloft of the low company have survived great wars and short-lived peace, for a diplomat's overt legacy is not only their work but also their affiliate(s) bequest and longevity.

4. Rumi –

"Out beyond ideas of wrongdoing and right doing, there is a field. I'll meet you there."

As iterated before, no Sufi list can start or end without the words of Rumi – perhaps the best recognised of the Sufi poets. In what may be Rumi's best-known verse lies a diplomat's most gatekept secret – ruse. As diplomats mature, a peculiar loneliness may accompany their success. Perhaps it is their blind devotion to their portfolio that leads them here as they navigate through moral ambiguity, transcending notions of good and bad, right and wrong, true and untrue. Perhaps the most understated and contentious ideal of an untouchable diplomat is – their untouchable iniquity. A diplomat's greatest wish is to meet their portfolio's expectations, dwelling in the elusive grey area between darkness and the unseen light for that pursuit from time-to-time

An example of a Press Conference report is given below:

(MMUN'21)

NO! THAT'S A BASELESS ACCUSATION.

~The Reuters, Haaretz and Al-Jazeera

On the last day of Maria's Model United Nations - 2021, a press conference was conducted in the United Nations Security Council by the representatives of Haaretz, Reuters and AlJazeera.

Reporter - To the delegate of Russia, the delegate had, in their speech in the moderated caucus, condemned the building of the American embassy in Jerusalem, and the American support towards the Israelis. why does the delegate feel the Israelis are undeserving of American support, when they themselves, have, on numerous occasions, stated Israel as a major ally?

The delegate of Russia - Although we do not condemn the alliance of the US with Israel, Russia as well is an ally of Israel on economic grounds, however, ma'am, we do not support the United States building a US embassy, particularly in Jerusalem. Why ma'am? Because international law clearly states that Jerusalem is supposed to be a common capital for Israel and Palestine, and the United States are not only the United States of America, it is a P5 nation, and them building an embassy just for Israel in Jerusalem, it may further instigate a conflict because they have not done so for Palestine.

Reporter - To the delegate of Kuwait, just after the Gulf War, Kuwait had enforced the exodus of 200,000 Palestinians from the state. Yet the delegate had called out for peace in their speech and said it is of utmost importance that the world is united in support of Palestine. What does the delegate have to say about this?

The delegate of Kuwait - All I want to say is that we support peace and even though we had past instances when Palestinians were deported, like you said, but that was when Iraq had occupied Kuwait, at that time, the Palestinian government had taken the side of the Iraqi government, because of that, the population of Palestinians living in Kuwait were not happy and were displeased the actions, but that was all in the past, the Kuwaiti government stand with the Palestinian brothers and sisters because all they want is peace in the Middle East and an end to this conflict.

Reporter - So who is the delegate really blaming for what happened in the past? Is the delegate blaming PLO or Iraq?

The delegate of Kuwait: If we continue to blame other countries, then no solution would ever evolve. We need to stop blaming people here and there, and only then we can come up with a solution for the end of this conflict.

Reporter: So, does Kuwait take full responsibility for what happened in the past regarding the exodus of the Palestinians?

The delegate of Kuwait: As I said, it was just because the population of Kuwait was displaced by the actions of the Palestinian government for supporting the Iraqi government when Iraq had occupied Kuwait.

Reporter: To the delegate of Palestine, is the Fatah government willing to reconsider its relations with Hamas for the sake of having a unified government over the Gaza Strip? If so, what shall be the conditions?

The delegate of Palestine: First of all, the state of Palestine is considering having elections again, so that the results of the election can be respected and for the better coordination of the two patches we will surely look forward to having a unified government in both the places.

Reporter: But could the delegate mention the conditions?

The delegate of Palestine: If the Hamas comes to power again, they will be restricted from a lot of extreme actions they take and the PLO will make sure of that. Reporter: Experts say that one of the

root causes of the modern conflict comes from British colonialism and specifically the Balfour declaration, what does the delegate of the United Kingdom have to say about it?

The delegate of the United Kingdom: Regarding the Balford declaration, the conflict between Israel and Palestine had just begun and at that time it was impossible to ascertain the feasibility of the solution we had proposed. Over the years as the conflict has unfolded for about 80 years now, the United Kingdom has seen the changes that has taken place now and has decided that the two-state solution and separation of Jerusalem happens to be the most feasible solution.

Reporter: What does the delegate of Israel have to say about the targeted killings by the Shin Bet of Hamas officials in the past? How does the delegate justify clandestine cross-border operations without approval?

The delegate of Israel: The allegations put against us we do not accept the fact that we did so. And secondly, any of the operations for the safety and security for our own people we are surrounded by some terrorist organizations by some nations who do not even want us to exist. Our actions have always been compelled by the fact that we as the state of Israel are solely responsible for the protection of our people and citizens and yes, we will do everything we can to ensure it.

Reporter: In response to my previous question, the delegate of Israel has said that they have mentioned it countless of times that everything they do is for the safety and protection of their people, but it has been seen in acts committed by the Israeli Mossad against innocent Palestinian civilians, although not termed as 'terrorism' because it has been done by a legal governmental institution, they are still crimes against humanity, acts of terror committed mostly innocent Palestinian civilians which has resulted in the death of many including children. What does the delegate have to say about that?

The delegate of Israel: We deny the allegations as they are baseless accusations. The state of Israel denies the baseless and one-sided accusations against us.

Reporter: Israel has been called an Apartheid State for a very long period of time. What does the delegate of Israel have to say about that?

The delegate of Israel: The allegations against our nation in the past, currently, or in the future, we've already stated that these are baseless and we are not surprised by the one-sided lookout of a large number of media houses as well as nations towards the issue. They do not look at both the sides, alleging anything against us. All the allegations are baseless, and the Israeli government has taken every action considering the security, sovereignty of the Israeli people.

Reporter: What does the delegate of Israel plan to do about the nearly seven million displaced Palestinian refugees around the globe who are denied the right to go back to their homeland, the Israeli-Palestinian region?

The delegate of Israel: The reason why these 7 million Palestinians are unable to return to their homeland is because this conflict has been carried upon for a long time and has been magnified. We believe any solution that comes up for the issue will automatically dissolve that problem and that if in viable solution to both the sides, the PLO as well as the Israeli government, we would help provide support to all these refuges, but until then, the matter of the displacement stands in the hands of the Palestinian government, not us.

Reporter: In their speech, the delegate of Israel had mentioned that their country supports a national home for Jews in Jerusalem.

The delegate of Israel: What our stance on Jewish people living in Jerusalem, we as Jewish people have been suffering and have been discriminated for a long time, and this is the time we have the access to our holy sight and the right to live in a city where we believe is a holy sight.

Reporter: Then how does the delegate expect to be provided with a home in Jerusalem for all Israelis when Israel itself is and has been refusing to let Palestinians, who have their ancestral roots in Palestine, into Palestine, just for the sake of majoritarianism?

The delegate of Israel: The issue of the 7 million refugees has already been answered. And talking about our presence in Jerusalem, we have no issues if Palestinians are living in Jerusalem, because we have already mentioned in a lot of speeches that the Palestinians do not want to live with us and do not accept us, the Israeli people even has the right to live near them, and that concerns us.

Reporter: It is stated that there are about 10,000 people living in Jerusalem who have no legal status as their parents have different ID cards. What does the delegate of Israel plan to do about that?

The delegate of Israel: Regarding the issue of Israeli settlements or any other settlements in East Jerusalem the state of Israel is on the verge of considering the setup of a committee to determine the allocation problem which currently exists there. We would like to inform this to this platform that we are on the verge and there are some conditions to it and we would definitely like to talk about it in future committee sessions.

An example of An Interview Transcript is given below:

(KIIT MUN 2024)

<u>One Step at a Time – The Molecule Story</u>

Aditya Bhattacharjee interviews DISEC's delegate of China, trying to understand their motivations and roadmaps towards a nuclear-weapon-free world.

Q1. The Chinese government often affirms its commitment to a 'no first use' policy, but with rapid nuclear modernisation, both by nations and by non-state actors, how credible is China's commitment to non-proliferation? How does the representative reaffirm this, especially with the recent test firing of an Intercontinental Ballistic Missile [ICBM]?

A1. When it comes to the 'no first use' policy, we have been steadfast in our commitment, unlike other P5 nations, ever since we first used a nuclear weapon, and still support global disarmament, particularly for the USA, which has violated most treaties for its convenience.

Regarding the ICBM test, the trajectory was tested and verifiable by the USA. Their claim of unawareness is contradictory. All data shared by the government is clear and transparent, and our commitments remain intact. Any allegations are rubbish.

Q2. China has often criticised countries like the United States of America [USA] for its nuclear policies, yet it has been exponentially increasing its military budget over the last three years. As such, how is China's position and polity fundamentally different from that of the USA?

A2. In international forums, there is a term—'security dilemma,' the same dilemma that China feels from the USA, especially with its growing presence in Southeast Asia, escalating the Taiwan Strait crisis, and maintaining its presence in Northeast Asia. These policies make China insecure, and it's contradictory for the USA to not see how their hegemonic ambitions contradict their plea for disarmament. When a country places nuclear weapons in neighbouring nations, it creates problems for the countries that now possess them as well. The USA forces us to take up weapons to defend ourselves.

Q3. Given the risks posed by cyber-warfare on nuclear command and control systems, how secure is China's nuclear infrastructure? On the ante, how does China view allegations regarding its government engaging in cyber-nuclear warfare?

A3. It was underappreciated a couple of years back and China's technological advancements in

the field of cyber nuclear warfare was not up to the mark , but now that's not the case. The fact you're asking this question reflects that we've advanced technologically. However, that doesn't mean we are violating treaties at will. China has been careful with how treaties are managed, and our commitment, even to those we've signed but not ratified, stems from the fact that the USA has also failed to meet its responsibilities. Regarding nuclear infrastructure, we are glad to inform you that we have nuclear plants that cannot be vaporized, a phenomenal achievement by our government. We want to build on this by seeking international cooperation through the BRICS to establish infrastructure projects that are not vaporizable and serve humanity's cause.

Q4. Even as China advocates for disarmament across international forums, satellite images seem to reveal significant increases in nuclear missile silo constructions in China. How this expansion aligns with the nation's disarmament goals?

A4. Well, at no point of time should you think that increase in certain nuclear silos and disarmament initiatives ever collide with each other because these have a certain role in itself and of course when it comes to increasing the missile silos, it's also pertinent that the United States does so only as a deterrent against the United States and its allies in the region and nothing else. It's not about developing nuclear weapons to attack non-nuclear weapon states but it's only to act as a security cover for the People's Republic of China

THEMATIC PHOTOGRAPHY

Introduction

Thematic photography means choosing a specific subject or idea to focus on when taking pictures. Instead of shooting randomly, one picks a theme, like "hands at work" in a busy market. This focus helps eliminate distractions and saves time. By knowing what to look for, a photographer can target specific locations and subjects. This approach also helps develop a unique photography style over time. Ultimately, thematic photography provides direction and leads to a stronger, more cohesive body of work.

Themes

Diplomatic Duel

Capture scenes in which two delegates are engaged in passionate debate during the committee sessions. Try to look for intense eye contact and assertive body language. The best shots often come during heated Q&A sessions.

Silent Strategies

Photograph the quiet but crucial moments of note-passing and hushed planning during committee sessions. Try to focus on small groups gathered during unmoderated caucus, secret alliance formations, or delegates exchanging quick notes. These shots depict the real diplomatic work that happens between formal speeches.

Alliance Architecture

Document how the committee room naturally divides into distinct groups as discussions progress. Capture the physical patterns formed by different blocs as some delegates come together in tight circles. These shots tell the story of coalition formation.

Podium Presence

Speeches establish the tone for committee proceedings and demonstrate a delegate's understanding of their foreign policy, particularly during General Speakers' List (GSL) sessions. During these speeches, pay close attention to the delegates and capture their confident hand gestures, commanding posture, and the attention they receive from other delegates.

Moments of Mediation

Mediation is where a neutral third party facilitates dialogue between conflicting parties to reach a peaceful resolution. It is considered a fundamental and essential tool in the practice of diplomacy. Find scenes in which a mediator, usually a member of the executive board, steps in to bridge disagreements between delegates or opposing blocs. These shots show diplomacy in action.

COMPOSITION TIPS

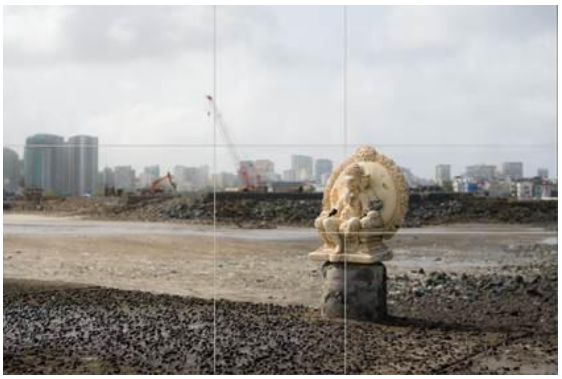
Composition refers to how elements are arranged within a photograph, including but not limited to the main subject. It is distinct from the subject itself, as it encompasses the entire frame. The human eye naturally prefers images with a sense of order and balance, while chaotic compositions are often less appealing. Good composition creates harmony and visual interest, while poor composition can detract from the image's impact. To improve composition, it's essential to understand and practice the various guidelines—often referred to as "rules"—that help structure an image effectively, keeping in mind that these are more flexible guidelines than strict rules.

Common Composition Techniques

The Rule of Thirds

The rule of thirds suggests dividing the image into nine equal sections, placing the subject at

one of the intersecting points rather than the center. This creates a more visually engaging composition, as the human eye tends to be drawn to off-center points of interest, making the image feel more balanced and dynamic.



Leading Lines

Lines, whether straight, diagonal, or curved, guide the viewer's eye through the photo. Leading lines can direct attention to specific elements, adding depth and drama. Diagonal lines, in particular, can create dynamic movement and a sense of infinity in an image.

Framing

In photography, a "natural frame" doesn't always mean a literal frame. It can refer to elements like doorways, arches, or tree branches that isolate the subject and direct the viewer's attention. By using natural frames, you can emphasize your subject and create a visual focus within the image.

Symmetry

Symmetry involves balancing both sides of an image to create harmony. It allows for breaking the rule of thirds and can be found in both nature and man-made elements. Look for symmetrical patterns, particularly those with strong lines or curves, which enhance the visual appeal of the image.

Viewpoint

The viewpoint can dramatically alter the mood of a photograph. For example, shooting a child from above makes them appear smaller or less significant, while shooting at eye level offers an equal perspective, and shooting from below can create a sense of dominance. Perspective also affects the perceived size of objects, such as emphasizing the height of a tree by shooting upward.

Understanding Technical Settings For Composition

Managing ISO and Noise: In a low-light environment like a classroom with artificial lighting, you might need to raise your ISO to capture enough light. However, increasing ISO can introduce noise (grain) into the image. A good starting point might be ISO 800-1600 but test in your specific lighting conditions to find the optimal balance. You could also use noise reduction softwares during post-processing if necessary.

Slowing Down Shutter Speed: If you're dealing with light banding or flicker from artificial lights, slowing down the shutter speed can help reduce this effect. Artificial lighting, especially fluorescent or LED lights, may cause a flickering effect that appears as horizontal bands across your images. A slower shutter speed can help smooth out this flickering. However, be mindful of motion blur if your subject is moving. A tripod can help stabilize the shot if you're using slower shutter speeds.

White Balance Adjustment: Cool, white/blue artificial lights often result in images with a cold, unnatural color cast. Adjust your camera's white balance to compensate for this.

Grid Lines for Composition: To help with compositional balance and alignment, enable the grid lines on your camera's viewfinder or screen. These lines divide the frame into thirds,

both horizontally and vertically, which aligns with the rule of thirds. Using grid lines can assist in positioning your subject or focal point at key intersections, creating a more dynamic and visually pleasing image.

GRADING CRITERIA

Each section will be scored out of a specific maximum total, and the final score will be a combination of the scores from each section.

Themes (5 photos total)

Capture one photo for each of the five aforementioned themes. Submissions will be graded based on:

Accuracy: Does the photo effectively depict the theme? Are the subject's facial expressions, body language, and overall mood clear and authentic?

Composition and Technique: Is the image technically well-executed with appropriate focus, exposure, and framing that enhances the emotional impact?

Organizing Committee (5-10 photos total)

Capture 5-10 photos of Organizing Committee (OC) members at work, focusing on candid moments and behind-the-scenes actions. Submissions will be graded based on:

Storytelling: Does the photo capture the behind-the-scenes action or effort of the

Organizing Committee? Does it provide insight into the OC's role and the event's inner workings?

Composition and Technique: Is the image technically well-executed with appropriate focus, exposure, and framing?

Composition Types (5 photos total)

Submit 1 photo each for 5 different composition techniques: Rule of Thirds, Leading Lines, Framing, Symmetry, and Viewpoint. Submissions will be graded based on:

Execution: Does the photographer effectively use the chosen compositional technique in a creative and visually striking way? Is the rule clearly incorporated into the shot?

Technique: Is the image technically well-executed with appropriate focus, exposure, and framing?

Miscellaneous Photos (5 photos total)

Submit 5 miscellaneous photos that don't fit the other categories. Submissions will be graded based on:

Creativity and Innovation: Are the photos unique, imaginative, or taken from an interesting perspective? Do they offer a fresh approach to capturing the event?

Composition and Technique: Is the image technically well-executed with appropriate focus, exposure, and framing?

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

Submission Deadline

The deadline for submission will be decided before the commencement of committee

sessions. Submissions must be on time, failure to do so will lead to a deduction in marks.

Image Editing

Editing is not mandatory; however, if you choose to edit your images, please keep adjustments minimal. Avoid over-editing, such as excessive sharpening, saturation, or heavy filters. The goal

is to enhance the photo while preserving its natural look and authenticity.

Submission Method

All images must be uploaded to the provided drive link. Photographers are required to create their own folder and organize their photos into 4 separate folders, one for each category:

1. Emotions
2. Compositions
3. Miscellaneous
4. Organizing Committee (OC)

Name each photo according to its category and specific emotion or composition type. Example:

1. Emotion_happiness_1.jpg
2. composition_ruleOfThirds_1.jpg
3. Misc_1.jpg
4. oc_1.jpg

Please ensure your files are well-organized and clearly labeled to facilitate the grading process.